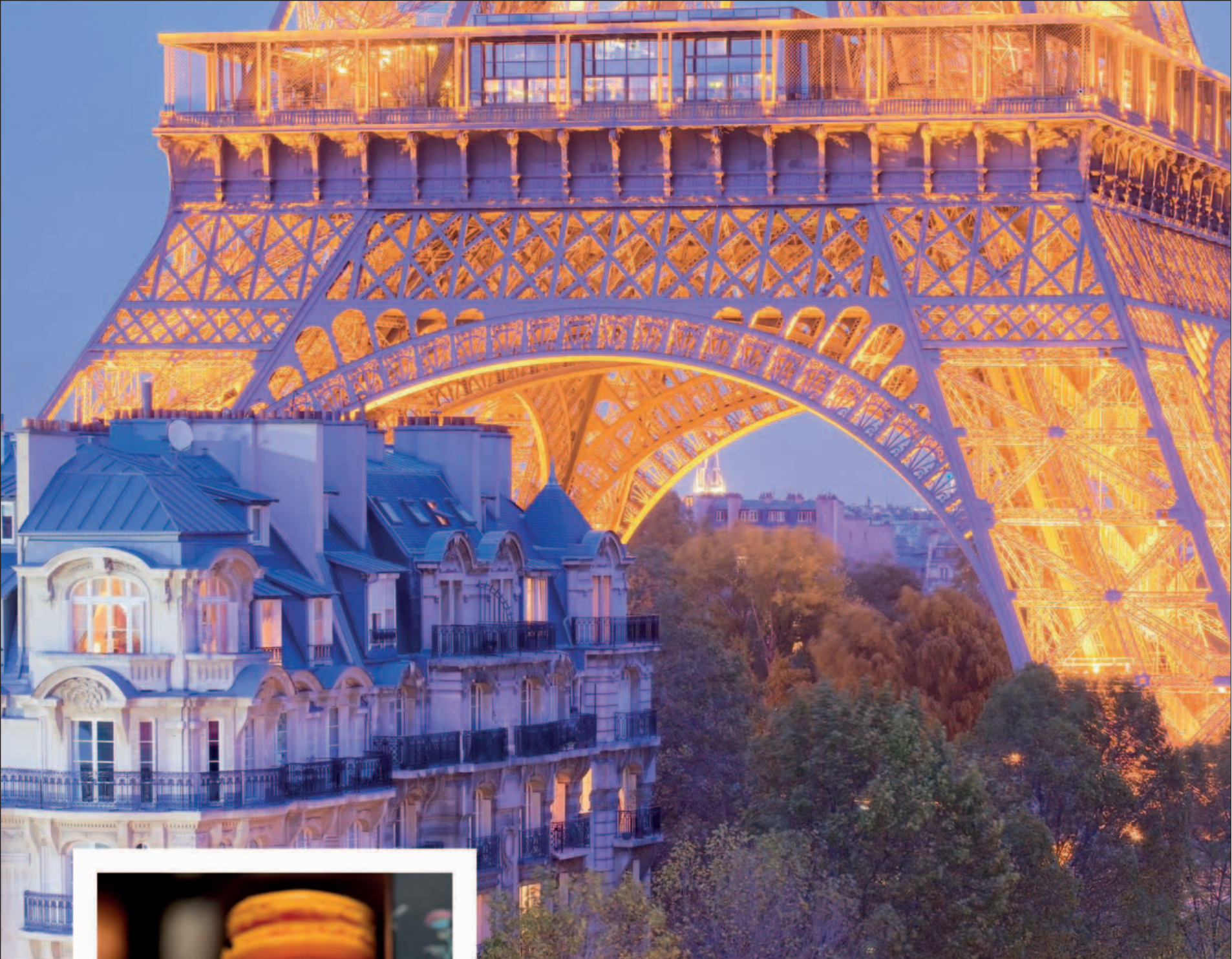




Above The iconic Eiffel Tower, built in 1889, towers over the pretty Parisian buildings in the 7th arrondissement



Above Macarons on display at Ladurée on rue Royale in Paris, where the family has been selling luxury cakes and pastries since 1871

A Day in Paris

Paris, the ultimate walking city, is teeming with sights. Skip your hotel breakfast and instead wander the neighborhood, taking in the scene, and grab your coffee and croissants at a café packed with locals.

MORNING Make your way to the chic **Marais** district and **Les Enfants Rouges**, Paris's oldest covered market, dating back to 1615. The evocative name recalls the children of a nearby orphanage, which closed in 1534, who uniformly wore red. Follow up with a *coup sur le zinc* (a pick-me-up – coffee or something stronger) at a local café.

AFTERNOON Ramble the *quais* of the Seine to the **Ile de la Cité**, stopping at the **Square du Vert Galant** to take in the grandeur of the **Louvre**. At the other end of the island, enjoy the view of **Notre Dame's** flying buttresses. Scour the art galleries of **St Germain**.

EVENING Head for **Place de la Concorde** to parade up the **Champs Elysées**. Look out over the city from the top of the **Arc de Triomphe**, tracing the 12 radiating avenues to arches and obelisks in the east and the contemporary **La Grande Arche de la Défense** to the west.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Paris has two **airports**: Paris-Charles de Gaulle and Paris-Orly. The former has its own RER **metro** station; at Orly a **shuttle bus** links to the metro line.

WHERE TO STAY

Hôtel Jeanne d'Arc (inexpensive) is a cozy, family-run hotel in the history-soaked Marais district. www.hoteljeannedarc.com

Hôtels Paris Rive Gauche (moderate) boasts five bijou properties on the Left Bank. www.hotels-paris-rive-gauche.com

Paris institution **Le Meurice** (expensive) has public spaces by Philippe Starck (those chairs sporting ladies' shoes), while rooms channel luxurious Louis XVI. www.lemeurice.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.parisinfo.com